

Phase 3: Project Design

Streamlining IT Procurement: Automating Standard Laptop Orders with Flow Designer

Team ID	SWTID-2026-6800	Team Size	5
Team Leader	Yuvaraj	Platform	ServiceNow Flow Designer
Team Members	Sakthivel.s, K. Santhosh kumar, Santhosh.R, Aathisankaran.R	Project Type	Process Automation (ITSM / Service Catalog)

1. Problem-Solution Fit

The table compares the customer problem with the designed solution to confirm they match.

Aspect	Details
Customer segment	Employees requesting laptops; IT procurement and hardware teams
Problem	Configuration of standard laptops is delayed or forgotten because the task is created by hand
Current alternative	Manual follow-ups, emails and memory
Solution	Flow Designer flow that automatically creates and assigns a catalog task to the Hardware group
Trigger for action	Order placed on Standard Laptop catalog item
Channel	ServiceNow Service Catalog and the Hardware group's task queue
Measurable result	Zero manual task creation; tasks present for every standard laptop request

2. Solution Architecture

The architecture has three layers that work together:

Layer	Component	Role
Presentation	Service Catalog > Hardware > Standard Laptop; Order Status page	Where the user orders and tracks the request
Process	Catalog item Process Engine set to Flow "Standard Laptop task"	Connects the catalog item to automation
Automation	Flow Designer: Service Catalog trigger and Create Catalog Task action	Generates and configures the task
Data	sc_request, sc_req_item, sc_task	Stores request, item and task records
Fulfilment	Hardware assignment group	Receives and configures the laptop

Flow Structure

Step	Element	Configuration
Trigger	Service Catalog	Starts when a catalog item request is submitted

Step	Element	Configuration
Action 1	Create Catalog Task	Request Item = Trigger > Requested Item; Table = Catalog Task [sc_task]
Fields	Short description	Laptop needs to Configured
Fields	Description	Laptop needs to Configured
Fields	Assignment group	Hardware
Fields	Approval	Approved
Option	Wait	Enabled, so the flow waits for the task to complete

3. Customer Journey

Stage	User action	System response	Experience
Discover	Opens Service Catalog and selects Hardware	Shows hardware items	Easy to find the item
Order	Opens Standard Laptop and clicks Order Now	Creates REQ and RITM, shows Order Status	Instant confirmation
Approve	Approver approves the request	Approval state changes	Clear decision point
Automate	No action required	Flow creates the catalog task and assigns it to Hardware	No manual step
Configure	Hardware team opens the task	Task shows short description and group	Prompt configuration
Deliver	Receives configured laptop	Task closed, RITM progresses	Shorter wait time

4. Design Decisions

- **Flow Designer over the legacy Workflow Editor:** it is the current ServiceNow standard and easier to maintain.
- **Run as System User:** ensures the task is always created, regardless of the requester's roles.
- **Global scope:** keeps the flow available to the catalog item without scope restrictions.
- **Single attached engine:** the catalog item's Process Engine allows only one engine, so other automations are removed and the flow is added.

5. Outcome of the Phase

The architecture, flow structure and user journey were finalised and approved for planning and development.